Student Zone

Parent's Corner

Praise the Effort, Not Just the Result
Instead of saying, "You're so smart," try: "I'm proud of how hard you worked!"
This helps children develop a growth mindset and encourages them to keep trying.

Message to Kids

"Believe in yourself and stay curious! Ask questions, explore new ideas, learn from your mistakes, and never be afraid to try again. Every small step you take today helps you become a smarter, stronger and more confident person tomorrow."

OUR LEARNING PROGRAMS

To Subscribe News Paper call us at: 9353387479 Visit: skillupjuniors.com

Vol.I
OCTOBER 2026
SKILLUPJUNIORS *Presents*

JUNIOR NEWS EXPRESS

India's Skill Development Newspaper for Kids

NEWS · ZONE

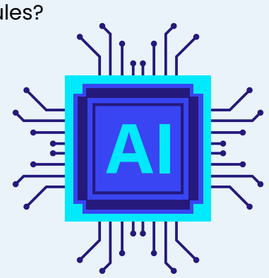
The world is asking an important question

But there is another important question:
Should only a few powerful countries and technology companies decide the rules?
Many developing countries say no.
They want a bigger voice in deciding how AI is developed and used. They also want better access to computers, technology, skills and knowledge so that developing countries are not left behind.

WHY DOES AI NEED RULES?
Imagine your school has a very powerful new machine.
It can answer questions, create pictures and help students learn.
Would you allow everyone to use it without any rules?
Probably not!
You might create rules such as:

- Use it for learning.
- Check whether its answers are correct.
- Don't use it to bully someone.
- Don't share someone's private information.
- Don't use it to cheat.

Ask an adult when something is unclear.
AI needs similar safeguards.



WHY SHOULD EVERY COUNTRY HAVE A VOICE?
Think about a classroom.
If only the three strongest students were allowed to make all the classroom rules, would that be fair?
Probably not.
The UN discussions highlighted the importance of giving developing countries a stronger role in shaping AI rules and standards.
Different countries have different needs, languages, cultures and challenges.
So the goal is to create AI rules through cooperation, rather than allowing only a small group to decide everything.

Artificial Intelligence, or AI, is becoming part of our everyday lives.
It can help us learn, translate languages, find information, create pictures, study science and even help doctors.
But AI can also create problems if it is used carelessly.
So, a big question is being discussed around the world:

Who should make the rules for AI?

In September 2026, world leaders gathered at the United Nations and discussed how countries should work together to make AI safer and fairer.
The United Nations says AI should be developed in a way that is safe, transparent and accountable, while keeping human dignity at the centre.

AI CAN DO GREAT THINGS
AI can help people in many ways.
HEALTH: AI can help doctors study medical information and find patterns.
EDUCATION: AI can help students understand difficult topics and practise new skills.
FARMING: AI can help farmers study weather and crops.
WEATHER: AI can help scientists study weather and climate patterns.
SCIENCE: AI can help researchers analyse huge amounts of information.
The UN says AI has enormous potential to improve areas such as medicine, scientific discovery, education and sustainable development.

BUT AI CAN ALSO CREATE RISKS
AI can sometimes produce wrong information.
It can also be used to create fake images, videos or stories.
There are concerns about:

- Fake information
- Privacy
- Bias and unfair decisions
- Job changes
- Cybersecurity
- Misuse of powerful AI systems

That is why people are asking for responsible rules.

BODY ORGANS

Instructions: Match the functions to each organ.

Helps us breathe by taking oxygen in, and sending carbon dioxide out.

Takes waste out of the blood and makes urine.

A small and large part that absorbs food and water, and excretes waste.

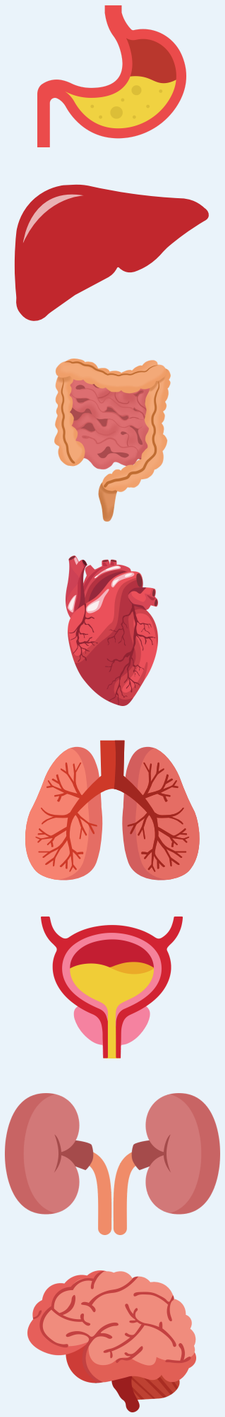
Pumps blood around the body to keep us alive.

Digests food.

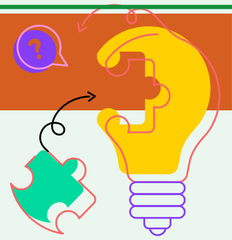
Cleans our blood, produces bile, and stores sugar.

The control centre for speech, coordination, memory, thoughts and emotions.

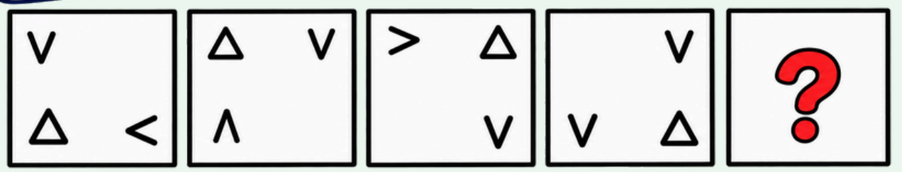
Stores and releases urine.

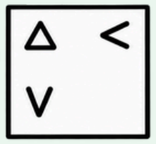


Logical & Reasoning Challenge

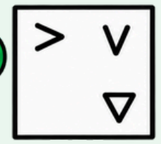


Question: Select the figure which will come next in the following series:



a. 

b.

c. 

d.

In following letter series, some of the letters are missing which are given in that order as one of the alternatives below it.
Choose the correct alternative.
b cab bc ab bca _____ bca
a. bbca
b. acba
c. cabc
d. cacc

THE SEATING PUZZLE
Five children — A, B, C, D and E — are sitting in a row.
A is sitting at the extreme left.
E is sitting at the extreme right.
B is sitting immediately next to A.
D is sitting immediately next to E.
Who is sitting in the middle?
A) A
B) B
C) C
D) D

THE BUS STOP PUZZLE
Three buses — Red, Yellow and Blue — arrive at a school.
The Red bus arrives before the Yellow bus.
The Blue bus arrives after the Yellow bus.
The Yellow bus does not arrive first.
What is the correct order?
A) Yellow → Red → Blue
B) Red → Yellow → Blue
C) Blue → Yellow → Red
D) Red → Blue → Yellow

THE MYSTERY OF THE THREE BOXES
There are three boxes: Red, Blue and Green.
The Red box is not the heaviest.
The Blue box is heavier than the Green box.
The Green box is heavier than the Red box.
Which box is the heaviest?
A) Red
B) Blue
C) Green
D) Cannot be determined

THE FOUR FRIENDS AND THEIR HOBBIES
Arjun, Diya, Kabir and Meera each enjoy a different hobby: drawing, cricket, reading and music.
Arjun does not like cricket or music.
Diya loves reading.
Kabir does not like drawing.
Meera does not like cricket.
If Arjun likes drawing, which hobby must Kabir have?
A) Drawing
B) Cricket
C) Reading
D) Music

THE TRICKY AGE PUZZLE
A mother is 24 years older than her daughter.
In 6 years, the mother will be twice as old as her daughter.
How old is the daughter today?
A) 6 years
B) 12 years
C) 18 years
D) 24 years

For Answers join our skillup juniors whatsapp Community or text us at 9353387479

INDIA BUILDS A GREEN ENERGY HIGHWAY!

How India plans to move more clean electricity

Imagine your school has a huge solar panel on its roof.
On a sunny day, it makes lots of electricity.
But how do we send that electricity to a school, home or factory far away?
We need power lines and a strong electricity network.
That is where the Green Energy Corridor comes in.

WHAT IS A GREEN ENERGY CORRIDOR?

A Green Energy Corridor is a special network of power lines and electricity systems that helps carry electricity made from clean sources such as:

- Solar power
- Wind power
- Hydropower

Think of it like a highway for electricity.
Just as roads carry cars from one place to another, power lines carry electricity to the places where people need it.

A BIG NEW STEP

The Union Cabinet has approved Green Energy Corridor Phase-III (GEC-III).
The project is planned to help India move up to 135 GW of renewable energy across different States and Union Territories.
The project is planned to be completed by 2032–33.
But what is 135 GW?
Don't worry about the big number!
1 GW = 1,000 MW.
For young readers, the important thing to remember is:

- 135 GW = A HUGE AMOUNT OF CLEAN ENERGY!

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN THE SUN IS NOT SHINING?

Solar power has one small problem.

- Daytime: Lots of sunlight → lots of solar electricity
- Night: No sunlight → no solar electricity from solar panels

So where can we keep extra electricity?

BATTERIES!

The new project also includes 50 GWh of battery storage.
These large batteries can store electricity when there is plenty of power and help provide it when it is needed.
Think of it like your school water bottle.
You fill it when water is available and use it later when you are thirsty.
Batteries do something similar with electricity.

HOW BIG IS THE PROJECT?

The total project cost is about:
₹1.86 LAKH CRORE
That is a very large amount of money!
A big part will be used to improve power networks inside states, while ₹50,000 crore is planned for battery storage.

WHY DOES THIS MATTER TO US?

You might wonder:
"How does a power corridor affect me?"
A stronger electricity network can help move more clean power to where it is needed.
That can support:

- Homes
- Schools
- Hospitals
- Factories
- Transport
- Businesses

And when more renewable energy is connected to the electricity network, India can make greater use of solar and wind power.

WHY CLEAN ENERGY?

Most of us use electricity every day.
We need it for:

- Lights
- Phones
- Fans and air-conditioners
- Computers
- Trains
- Hospitals
- Factories

If more of this electricity comes from renewable sources, it can help India move towards a cleaner energy future.

DID YOU KNOW?
India is adding solar and wind power quickly.
But making clean electricity is only half the job.
The electricity must also reach the people who need it.
That's why power lines, substations and batteries are so important.

INDIA & NEW ZEALAND: A NEW TRADE PARTNERSHIP

A new agreement could bring more Indian products, jobs and opportunities

India and New Zealand have signed a **Free Trade Agreement (FTA)** that is set to come into force on 20 October 2026.

WHAT IS AN FTA?

magine two countries are trading toys.
Country A sends toys to Country B. But before the toys enter Country B, an extra tax called a customs duty may be charged.
A Free Trade Agreement can reduce or remove some of these taxes and make it easier for the two countries to trade with each other.

WHAT DOES THIS MEAN FOR INDIA?

Under the India–New Zealand FTA, 100% of Indian exports will receive zero-duty access to the New Zealand market when the agreement enters into force.
That means many Indian products can become more competitive in New Zealand because they will no longer face import duties.
Some of the sectors expected to benefit include:

- Textiles & clothing
- Leather & footwear
- Engineering products
- Pharmaceuticals
- Agricultural products
- Processed food

The agreement is also expected to create opportunities for MSMEs, farmers, entrepreneurs and workers.

A BIG INVESTMENT PROMISE

New Zealand has committed to facilitating US$20 billion of investment in India over 15 years.
Investment means putting money into businesses, factories, projects or other activities that can help create economic activity and jobs.
The two countries also aim to increase their bilateral trade to around ₹35,000 crore over the next four to five years.

WHAT ABOUT INDIAN FARMERS?

India has kept several sensitive agricultural and other sectors protected from tariff commitments.
These include areas such as dairy and several agricultural products, along with some other products.
This means trade agreements do not simply mean “remove every tax on everything.” Countries can choose which sectors to open and which sectors to protect.

WHAT CAN INDIA AND NEW ZEALAND SHARE?

New Zealand is well known for products such as kiwifruit, apples, honey, dairy and other agricultural products.
The agreement includes cooperation and specific arrangements related to products such as kiwifruit and apples, while India's sensitive agricultural sectors remain protected.
This can give consumers more choices while allowing countries to protect important domestic sectors.

WHY DOES THIS MATTER?

Think about a small Indian company making shoes.
Before an FTA, its shoes entering another country might face an import duty.
If that duty is removed, the shoes may become more competitive in that market.
If more people buy them, the company may need to:
Make more products → hire more people → buy more materials → grow the business.
That is one reason trade agreements can matter to businesses and workers, not just governments.

THINK ABOUT IT

Imagine you start a company in India making eco-friendly school bags.
You want children in New Zealand to use your bags.
What could make it easier for your company to sell there?
A. Higher import taxes
B. Lower or zero import duties
C. Stopping international trade
D. Making the bags more expensive

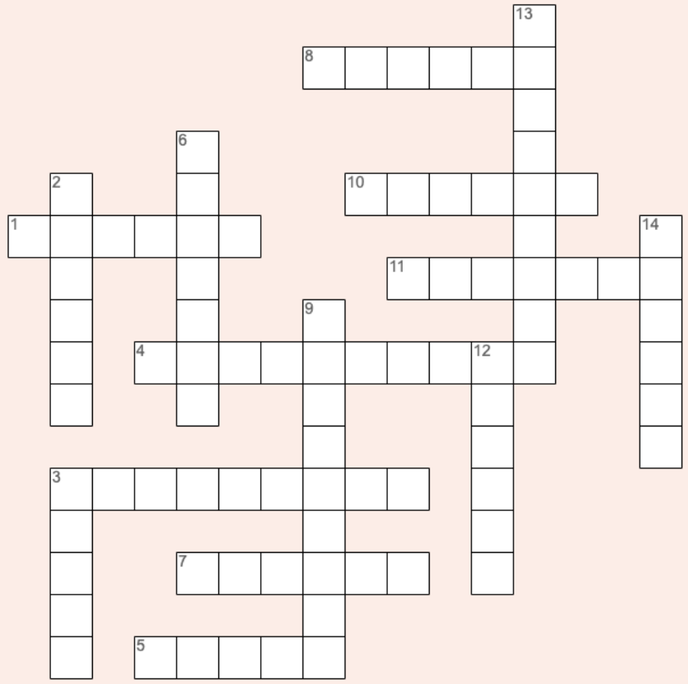
Answer: _____

why: _____

_____

Fun Learning: THINK. SOLVE. WIN!

CROSSWORD PUZZLE



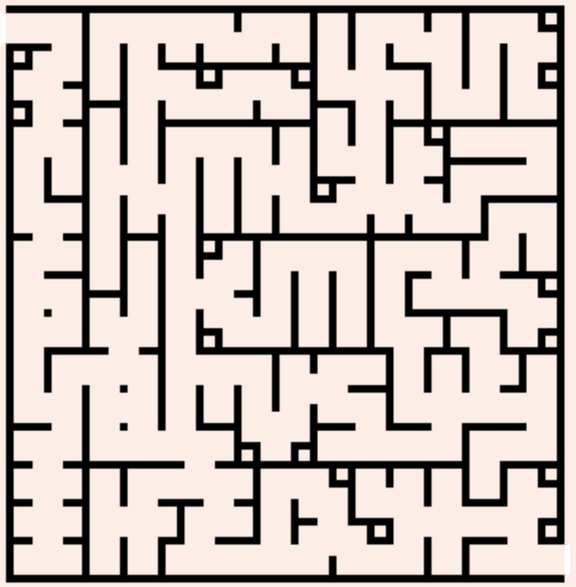
ACROSS
1. Rapidly rotating neutron star
3. Word puzzle
4. Layer of gas around a planet
5. Path around a celestial body
7. Collection of stars and planets
8. Cloud of gas and dust in space
10. Brain teaser
11. When one celestial body blocks another

DOWN
2. Distant bright object in space
3. Icy space traveler with a tail
6. Force pulling objects together
9. Space explorer in a suit
12. Vehicle for space travel
13. Object orbiting a planet
14. Shooting star in the sky

SUDOKU:FILL MISSING NUMBERS

6						2		4
7	1				2	6	5	8
4			5			7	3	
2	4		8	6	5	3	1	7
5				3	1			2
	7		4		9	5		6
	5		3				2	9
	3		2	9				5
		4			8	1		

MAZE: FIND THE WAY



MY IDEA FOR A BETTER SOCIETY

JUNIORS WRITING CHALLENGE

"IF I WERE THE MAYOR..."

Imagine you are the Mayor of your city for ONE DAY! You notice one problem in your neighbourhood. It could be: Too much garbage, Traffic near schools, Not enough trees, Water wastage, Stray animals needing care, Elderly people needing help, Places that are difficult for people with disabilities, Children who don't have enough books.

12 YEARS OF MAKE IN INDIA

From ideas and factories to products used around the world

Have you ever looked at your mobile phone, a car, a train or a medicine packet and wondered:
"Where was this made?"
Many products are now being designed, built and assembled in India.
On 25 September 2026, Make in India completed 12 years. The initiative was launched in 2014 to encourage manufacturing, innovation, investment and new businesses in India.

What does "Make in India" mean?
Think about making a school bag.
First, someone designs it.
Then, materials are collected.
Workers make different parts.
Machines help with production.
The finished bag is packed and sent to shops.
This process is called manufacturing.
Make in India encourages more products and technologies to be made in India.

From phones to big machines
One of the biggest changes has happened in electronics.
India's electronics production has grown from about ₹2 lakh crore in 2014–15 to around ₹13 lakh crore in 2025–26.
Mobile-phone production has also grown hugely—from about ₹19,000 crore to around ₹6 lakh crore.
Today, India is one of the world's biggest mobile-phone manufacturing countries.
So, when you see a phone marked "Made in India," remember that many designers, engineers, technicians and workers may have helped make it.

It is not just about phones!
Make in India covers many industries:

- Cars and automobiles
- Electronics
- Medicines
- Railways
- Defence equipment
- Steel
- Advanced technology

Today, the programme covers 27 major sectors across manufacturing and services.

Where do young people fit in?
Factories need more than machines.
They need:

- Software developers
- Engineers
- Designers
- Scientists
- Business managers
- Robotics experts
- Technology specialists
- Logistics professionals

This means India's growing industries can create opportunities for people with many different skills.
Today's student could become tomorrow's inventor, engineer, designer or entrepreneur.

MAKE IN INDIA = MAKE WITH IDEAS
Manufacturing is not simply about making things.
It is also about solving problems.
Imagine you invent:

- A water bottle that reminds children to drink water.
- A school bag that becomes lighter when carried.
- A solar-powered study lamp.
- A toy that teaches mathematics.
- A device that helps farmers save water.

The idea starts in your mind.
Then comes:
IDEA → DESIGN → TEST → MAKE → IMPROVE

Can Indian products reach the world?
Yes!
When products made in India are sold to other countries, they become exports.
A strong manufacturing industry can help India:
Sell products around the world

- Create jobs
- Encourage new ideas
- Build stronger industries
- Attract investment

DID YOU KNOW?
India's manufacturing activity grew by about 7% during the first four months of the 2026–27 financial year.
That means that, roughly speaking, if a factory made 100 units last year, the industry made about 107 units this year during the same period.

SPEAK ABOUT IT

"If I could invent one product for India..."
What would you create?
Explain:

- What problem does it solve?
- Who would use it?
- How would it make life better?

THE BIG IDEA

Make in India is not only about factories. It is about ideas, skills, technology, hard work and people coming together to create something useful.
And perhaps one day, something you invent could be made in India and used around the world.
THINK. CREATE. MAKE.

WORLD TOURISM DAY 2026

Have you ever visited a new place and thought, “Wow! I want to know more about this place!”

That is what makes travelling so exciting!

Every year, 27 September is celebrated as World Tourism Day. It is a day to celebrate travel and learn about different places, people and cultures.

THIS YEAR, AI JOINS THE JOURNEY!

The theme of World Tourism Day 2026 is about Digital Technology and Artificial Intelligence (AI) in tourism.

But what does that mean?

It means that technology can help us plan and enjoy trips in new ways.

Imagine asking an AI travel helper:

“I have two days. I love animals, nature and history. Where should I go?”

AI could help suggest places, activities and routes.

Technology can also help us:

- Find places
- Translate languages
- Check the weather
- Find interesting attractions
- Find places to stay
- Learn about famous places

Pretty cool, right?

INDIA IS FULL OF AMAZING PLACES!

India has so many different places to explore.

- Mountains — Himalayas
- Beaches — Goa and Kerala
- Wildlife — National parks and tiger reserves
- Forts & Palaces — Rajasthan and many other states
- Temples & Monuments — Places with amazing history
- Festivals & Dance — Different traditions across India
- Food — Every state has its own special dishes!

From Kashmir to Kanyakumari, every place has a story.

DID YOU KNOW?

In 2025, people made more than 4 billion tourist visits within India.

That's a HUGE number!

India also welcomed about 25 million foreign tourist visits in 2025.

Tourism also gives jobs to millions of people.

These include:

- Chefs
- Hotel workers
- Drivers
- Tour guides
- Photographers
- Artists
- Nature guides

So tourism helps many families earn a living.

BE A SMART TRAVELLER

Visiting beautiful places is fun.

But we must also take care of them.

When you travel:

- Avoid plastic waste
- Use dustbins
- Don't damage plants
- Don't disturb animals
- Don't damage monuments
- Don't waste water
- Respect local people

Remember:

Take memories.

Leave the place clean.

TOURISM HELPS LOCAL PEOPLE

When tourists visit a place, they often buy things made by local people.

For example:

- Handmade clothes
- Paintings and crafts
- Local food
- Handmade products

This helps local families earn money.

It also helps keep old traditions and skills alive.

HOW CAN AI HELP TRAVELLERS?

Imagine your family wants to visit a new city.

You could ask an AI tool:

“Plan a one-day family trip with fun places, local food and a park.”

AI might help you make a plan.

But remember:

AI gives ideas. People make the final decisions.

We should check information carefully and never share private information with strangers or unknown websites.

MONEY SMART: NEED OR WANT?

NEEDS — WHAT WE REALLY NEED

A **Need** is something that is important for our health, safety, education or everyday life. We need certain things to live, learn and grow. For example, food, clean water, a safe home, basic clothes, medicine and education are needs. A student needs school books, notebooks and basic stationery to learn properly. If you are hungry, buying food is more important than buying a new toy. If your school shoes are broken and cannot be used, getting a suitable pair of shoes can become a need.

Needs should usually come before wants when we make spending decisions. This does not mean that every need costs a lot of money. Sometimes a simple choice can meet a need without spending too much. For example, carrying a water bottle from home can meet your need for water without buying a new drink every day.

Understanding needs helps children become responsible with money. When we know what is truly important, we can avoid wasting money on things we do not really require. Before asking parents to buy something, try asking yourself: “Do I really need this?”

Needs can also change depending on the situation. A raincoat may not be necessary on a sunny day, but it becomes useful when it is raining. Similarly, medicine may not be needed every day, but it becomes important when someone is sick.

WANTS — THINGS WE WOULD LIKE TO HAVE

Want is something we would like to have, but we can usually live without it. Wants can make us happy, comfortable or entertained, but they are not essential for our basic needs. For example, toys, video games, fancy clothes, expensive shoes, chocolates, the latest gadgets and extra snacks can be wants. There is nothing wrong with enjoying these things. The important thing is learning when and how to spend money on them.

Imagine you already have a school bag that is strong and works perfectly. You see a new bag with your favourite character and want to buy it. The new bag may be exciting, but it is probably a want, because you already have a bag that meets your need. Similarly, if you already have a working bicycle but want a newer model simply because it looks cooler, that new bicycle is usually a want.

Wants can be difficult to control because advertisements, friends and social media can make us feel that we need something immediately. A smart money habit is to pause before buying. Ask yourself: “Do I need this, or do I simply want it?” You can also wait for a day or a week before making the decision. Sometimes, you may discover that you do not want the item anymore. Wants are okay when they fit within our budget. But spending all our money on wants can leave nothing for important needs or savings.

ENGLISH VOCABULARY CHALLENGE

My Cryptogram

Decode themessage.Each letter maps to a different letter.

NGJ YWMBWM FM D YDUADM KDFUNJC EFNG NGJ EWUCJVM

___ _____ __ _ _____ _____ _____ ____ _____

WQ NFBJ DUC JUJVSX.

__ _____ ____ _____

Revealed letters: J = E

Your Decryption Key:

A = __ B = __ C=__ D = __ E = __ F = __ G = __
H = __ I = __ J = E K = __ L = __ M = __ N = __
O = __ P = __ Q=__ R = __ S = __ T = __ U = __
V = __ W = __ X= __ Y = __ Z = __

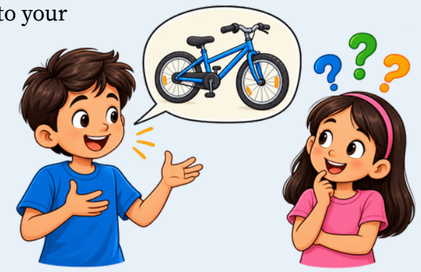
UPGRADE YOUR EVERYDAY ENGLISH

#	COMMON WORD	TRY THIS WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	EXAMPLE SENTENCE
1	Ask	Request	Ask for something politely.	I **requested** extra time to complete my project.
2	Tell	Mention	Say something briefly.	She **mentioned** the competition to her friends.
3	Help	Assist	Help someone.	Can you **assist** me with this activity?
4	Buy	Purchase	Get something by paying for it.	Dad **purchased** a new notebook for school.
5	Need	Require	Need something.	This project **requires** more time and teamwork.
6	Choose	Select	Pick one.	Please **select** your favourite topic for the presentation.
7	Fix	Repair	Make something work again.	Can you **repair** my bicycle?
8	Start	Begin	Start something.	The class will **begin** at 9 a.m.
9	Show	Demonstrate	Show how something works.	The teacher **demonstrated** the experiment.
10	Think about	Consider	Think carefully about something.	I will **consider** your idea before giving my answer.

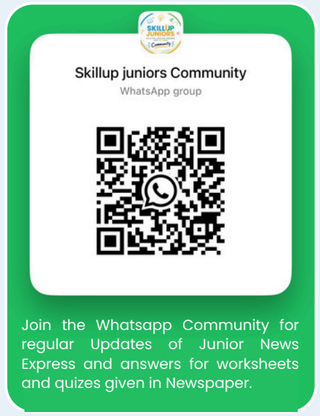
CHALLENGE: "SAY IT WITHOUT SAYING IT!"

Challenge: Explain a simple word or object to your friend without saying its name.

Example:
Your word is "BICYCLE"
You cannot say: bicycle, cycle, wheels
You can say: "It is something you ride. It has two tyres and you use your legs to move it."



Goal: Can your friend guess the word in 30 seconds?



A SAFER INDIA FOR EVERYONE

Why women's safety matters to every one of us

Imagine a city where every girl and woman can walk to school, travel by bus, go to work, play in a park or return home without fear.
That is what a safe society should look like.
Women make up almost half of India's population. Yet, concerns about safety can sometimes affect where women travel, when they go out and even the opportunities they choose. Unsafe roads, poor lighting, crowded transport and isolated places can make people feel uncomfortable or unsafe.
Is having laws enough?
India has several laws and programmes designed to protect women. There are Women Help Desks, One Stop Centres, Fast Track Special Courts, Safe City projects and the Nirbhaya Fund for safety-related initiatives. The emergency number 112 is also available for urgent assistance.
But here is an important question:
If a street has a streetlight that does not work, does simply having a safety policy make that street safe? Not really.
Safety also depends on whether the street is well-lit, whether public transport is reliable, whether help is available quickly and whether people behave responsibly.
A surprising fact
According to the NCRB's Crime in India 2024 data cited, India recorded 4,41,534 registered cases of crimes against women in 2024.
These numbers remind us that safety is not just a topic for governments and police.
It is a responsibility shared by society.

What can make cities safer?
A safer city can have:

- Well-lit streets
- Safe and reliable public transport
- Safe walking paths
- Responsive police and help desks
- Better-designed public spaces
- More women working in public-facing jobs
- Respectful behaviour from everyone

The editorial also points out that women make up only about 10% of India's police force, while broader policy goals aim for greater representation. More women in policing and other public-facing roles can make public institutions more accessible to women.
Safety begins with respect
Laws and technology are important—but good behaviour matters too.
Children can help build a safer society by learning to:

- Respect everyone's personal space.
- Never make fun of or bully someone because of their gender.
- Speak up when they see unfair or unsafe behaviour.
- Ask a trusted adult for help when something feels wrong.
- Treat girls and boys equally.
- Learn basic emergency and safety procedures.

Think Like a City Designer!
Imagine you are designing a new neighbourhood for children and families.
Ask yourself:

- Where would you put streetlights?
- Where would you place bus stops?
- How would you make a park feel safe?
- Where could people go to ask for help?

A good city is not simply one with tall buildings and busy roads.
A good city is one where people feel safe, respected and free to participate.

GENDER EQUALITY: ARE BOYS AND GIRLS GETTING EQUAL CHANCES?

The world still has a long way to go

Imagine a school where everyone gets the same chance to learn, play, lead, and share ideas. That is the basic idea behind gender equality — girls and boys should have equal opportunities and be treated with equal respect.

A new United Nations report called the Gender Snapshot 2026 shows that the world is making progress in some areas, but it is still moving too slowly. In fact, none of the gender-equality targets under the UN's Sustainable Development Goal 5 are currently on track to be achieved by 2030.

Who gets to make important decisions?

Women are still underrepresented in many leadership positions.

In 2026, women hold about 27% of seats in national parliaments around the world. That is better than about 22% in 2015, but it is still far from equal.

Women also make up only a small share of top leadership positions in business and the highest courts.

Why does leadership matter?

When different people get a chance to lead, they can bring different experiences and ideas to important decisions — from education and healthcare to jobs and the environment.

THINK ABOUT IT

If your classroom had a "Class Leader for a Day" activity, should only boys or only girls get the chance?
Why or why not?

Who does more work at home?

There is another interesting finding.

Around the world, women and girls spend about 2.5 times as many hours as men and boys on unpaid household and care work.

This can include cooking, cleaning, looking after younger children, caring for family members, and other jobs at home.

A simple lesson for kids

Housework is everyone's responsibility.

Boys and girls can both:

- Keep their room clean
- Help with dishes
- Help younger family members
- Organise their things
- Share household responsibilities

Small actions can help create a fairer home.

What about girls' rights?

The report also highlights serious challenges around the world.

Nearly 1 in 5 girls worldwide is married before turning 18. The report also estimates that about 230 million women and girls have survived female genital mutilation.

These issues show why protecting children's rights and giving every child the chance to learn, grow and make choices about their future is so important.

Education Can Make a Difference

Education gives children knowledge, confidence and more choices for their future.

A girl who learns science can become a scientist.

A girl who loves technology can become an engineer.

A girl who enjoys speaking can become a journalist, teacher or leader.

And boys can choose careers that involve caring, teaching or helping others too.

Your interests should help choose your future — not whether you are a boy or a girl.

DECISION MAKING CHALLENGE: WHAT WOULD YOU DO?

Read each situation carefully. Tick ✓ **ONE** option you would choose. Think about what could happen because of your decision.

1. Your friend forgot their lunch.

A. Give them some of yours	**B.** Ignore them	**C.** Make fun of them

2. You have 200 and want a toy, but your school needs a new notebook.

A. Buy the toy	**B.** Buy the notebook	**C.** Spend all the money on snacks

3. Your friends want you to copy homework from another student.

A. Copy it	**B.** Say no and do your own	**C.** Tell them to copy yours

4. You see a wallet on the playground.

A. Keep the money	**B.** Give it to a teacher	**C.** Leave it there

5. You have an important test tomorrow, but your friends invite you to play.

A. Play all evening	**B.** Study first, then play if you have time	**C.** Skip studying completely

6. Two friends are arguing and both want you to take their side.

A. Pick one immediately	**B.** Listen to both sides	**C.** Start arguing too

7. You receive a message from someone you don't know online.

A. Reply immediately	**B.** Share your personal details	**C.** Don't reply and tell a trusted adult

8. Your team loses a competition because of a mistake you made.

A. Blame a teammate	**B.** Hide the mistake	**C.** Admit it and learn from it

9. You promised your friend you would help, but you suddenly have your own important work.

A. Ignore your friend	**B.** Explain honestly and find another time to help	**C.** Lie about why you can't help

10. You want to buy something because everyone in your class has it.

A. Buy it immediately	**B.** Ask yourself if you really need it	**C.** Ask friends to lend you money

THINK LIKE A DECISION MAKER

Choose **any 3 situations** above and answer:

Situation No.	What did you choose?	Why did you choose it?
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

SKILL • ZONE

YOUNG ACHIEVERS OF THE FORTNIGHT

THE 15-YEAR-OLD WHO SET OUT TO HELP 4,500 STUDENTS

VISHNUPRIYA PAI'S AMAZING 51-SCHOOL JOURNEY

What if a school student decided to help thousands of other students feel less stressed about exams?

That is exactly what **15-year-old Vishnupriya Pai**, a Class 10 student from Alva's Central School in Moodbidri, Karnataka, did.

Between 24 August and 11 September 2026, Vishnupriya travelled across Karnataka and visited 51 schools in just 15 days. She conducted one-hour sessions for students on exam stress, time management, effective study techniques and examination preparation. Her initiative reached around 4,500 students and was recognised by the Golden Book of World Records.

Vishnupriya's interest in psychology, counselling and mental well-being began when she was in Class 6. Over the following years, she completed online courses to learn more about these subjects.

Instead of keeping her knowledge to herself, she decided to share it with other students who might also feel nervous or confused during exam time.

Her message was simple: exam anxiety can be managed with preparation, planning and a positive approach.

Travelling to 51 schools in 15 days was not easy. She had to meet new students, speak confidently and deliver useful sessions at every school.

Her achievement shows that age does not decide how much you can contribute.

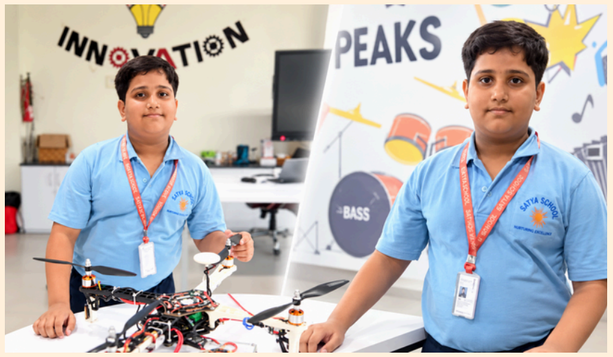
WHAT CAN WE LEARN FROM HER?

You don't have to wait until you are an adult to make a difference.

Learn something. Share it. Help someone.

Sometimes, one young person with a good idea can inspire thousands.

THE 11-YEAR-OLD WHO LOOKED FOR ASTEROIDS



ALL-INDIA ASTEROID SEARCH CAMPAIGN (AIASC) 2026

For **11-year-old Atharv Sood,** looking at the night sky is more than just a hobby. His curiosity about the Moon, planets and distant galaxies has taken him into the world of real scientific research.

Atharv, a Class 6 student at Satya School, participated in Phase I of the **All-India Asteroid Search Campaign (AIASC) 2026** through his school's Young Scientist Programme. He was credited with three preliminary asteroid detections and was recognised by the **International Astronomical Search Collaboration (IASC)** as part of Team SPACE Scanners 1.

His journey began at home when his parents gifted him a telescope for his birthday. Atharv used it to observe the Moon, Jupiter and other objects in the sky. Soon, his curiosity grew into a deeper interest in astronomy.

During the asteroid search campaign, Atharv and other students were trained to study real astronomical images using Astrometrica, a special software program. They compared images taken at different times and carefully looked for tiny objects that appeared to move against the background of stars.

Finding a possible asteroid required patience, concentration and careful checking.

For Atharv, the most exciting part was not simply receiving recognition—it was getting the chance to experience how scientists actually search the skies.

His story reminds us that big discoveries can begin with a small question.

WHAT CAN WE LEARN?

Stay curious. Keep learning. Ask questions. Your next big discovery could start with something you notice today!

To publish your Stories, Achievements, Art Work, Articles, Winning Prizes share at: **skillupjuniors@gmail.com**

ISRO LAUNCHES EOS-05

INDIA GETS A NEW EYE IN SPACE!

On 4 September 2026, ISRO successfully launched EOS-05, an Earth-observation satellite, using the GSLV-F17 rocket from Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh.

EOS-05 is special because it is India's first imaging satellite placed in a geosynchronous orbit. From high above Earth, the satellite will help observe our planet and collect useful information.

INDIA WINS WOMEN'S ASIA CUP!

CHAMPIONS AGAIN!

India's women's cricket team became Asia Cup champions for a record eighth time after defeating Sri Lanka by 72 runs in the final on 13 September 2026 in Dubai.

India scored 183 runs for 5 wickets. Openers Shafali Verma (68) and Smriti Mandhana (59) played brilliantly and shared a huge 129-run partnership.

India's bowlers then took control. Shree Charani took 4 wickets and Deepti Sharma took 3, helping India bowl Sri Lanka out for just 111 runs.

India also remained unbeaten throughout the tournament.

UN WARNS ABOUT RISING SEA LEVELS

THE OCEAN IS RISING — WHY DOES IT MATTER?

In September 2026, the United Nations warned that rising sea levels are becoming a serious global problem. As the Earth gets warmer, glaciers and ice sheets melt, while warmer ocean water expands. Both cause sea levels to rise.

In 2024, global sea levels rose by nearly 6 millimetres in one year – the highest annual rise ever recorded.

Around 770 million people live in low-lying coastal areas that are less than five metres above the high-tide level. Countries and cities near the sea, including Mumbai and Kolkata, face growing risks from flooding and coastal changes.

INTERNATIONAL LITERACY DAY

READING OPENS DOORS TO A BETTER FUTURE!

8 SEPTEMBER is celebrated as International Literacy Day around the world. In 2026, the day marked its 60th anniversary with the theme "Literacy for people, the planet and prosperity."

Literacy means being able to read, write and understand information. It helps people learn new things, make better decisions and take part in society.

But millions of young people and adults around the world still lack basic literacy skills. UNESCO says about 739 million youth and adults did not have basic literacy skills in 2024

PM VISHWAKARMA COMPLETES 3 YEARS

SUPPORTING INDIA'S TRADITIONAL ARTISANS

The PM Vishwakarma Scheme, launched on 17 September 2023, completed three years in September 2026. The scheme supports traditional artisans and craftspeople with skill training, modern tools, loans and help in finding bigger markets.

Around 30 lakh artisans have registered under the scheme, while about 24.5 lakh have received basic skill training. More than 18 lakh modern toolkits have also been provided.

The scheme covers 18 traditional trades, including carpenters, potters, tailors, goldsmiths, barbers, cobblers, masons and toy makers.

From a Young Lawyer to a Leader of India's Freedom Movement

MAHATMA GANDHI: THE JOURNEY OF A LEADER

Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi was born on **October 2, 1869, in Porbandar, Gujarat**. He later became widely known as Mahatma Gandhi.

But Gandhi's journey was not simply the story of a freedom fighter. It was the story of a person who experimented with ideas, learned from his experiences and gradually developed a philosophy based on truth, non-violence and peaceful action.

THE SOUTH AFRICA CHAPTER

In 1893, Gandhi travelled to South Africa to work as a lawyer.

During his years there, he experienced racial discrimination. One famous incident occurred when he was removed from a first-class railway compartment despite having a valid ticket.

Instead of responding with violence, Gandhi began thinking about how injustice could be challenged peacefully.

He developed and practised the idea of Satyagraha — a method of standing firmly against injustice through truth and non-violence.

His experiences in South Africa shaped many of the ideas that he later brought to India.

GANDHI RETURNS TO INDIA

Gandhi returned to India in 1915.

He travelled around the country to understand the lives and problems of ordinary people.

Soon, he became involved in movements connected with farmers, workers and India's struggle against British rule.

Some important movements associated with Gandhi:

CHAMPARAN SATYAGRAHA — 1917

Farmers in Champaran, Bihar, faced problems connected with the cultivation of indigo under the system imposed by European planters.

Gandhi went to Champaran, investigated the farmers' problems and supported their demands through peaceful action.

Why it matters:

It became one of Gandhi's first major Satyagraha movements in India.

KHEDA SATYAGRAHA — 1918

Farmers in Kheda, Gujarat, were facing difficult conditions after crop failure.

Gandhi supported their demand for relief from land revenue payments.

Lesson:

Standing together peacefully can help communities raise their concerns.

NON-COOPERATION MOVEMENT — 1920–1922

Gandhi called upon Indians to withdraw cooperation from British institutions and goods as part of a mass movement.

People were encouraged to:

- Boycott foreign cloth
- Promote khadi
- Support Indian-made goods
- Leave certain government institutions
- Participate in peaceful protests

The movement became one of the largest mass movements of the period.

It was withdrawn by Gandhi in 1922 after violence occurred at Chauri Chaura.

THE SALT MARCH — 1930

One of Gandhi's most famous journeys began on March 12, 1930.

Gandhi and a group of followers walked from Sabarmati Ashram to Dandi, covering roughly 390 kilometres.

Why salt?

Salt was something that every person needed, yet the British government controlled its production and taxation.

On April 6, 1930, Gandhi broke the salt law at Dandi.

The simple act became a powerful symbol of resistance.

QUIT INDIA MOVEMENT — 1942

During the Second World War, Gandhi and the Indian National Congress launched the Quit India Movement in August 1942.

The movement called for an end to British rule in India.

Gandhi gave the famous call:

"Do or Die."

The movement led to widespread protests and arrests across India.

Gandhi was also imprisoned.

The movement became an important chapter in the final phase of India's struggle for independence.

Gandhi was also a newspaper and journal publisher.

He understood that ideas could travel through the printed word.

Instead of depending only on public speeches, Gandhi used newspapers and journals to communicate with people, explain his ideas and discuss important social issues.

The Gandhi Heritage Portal records several journals that he owned, edited or published.

INDIAN OPINION

Gandhi became closely associated with Indian Opinion, a newspaper started in South Africa in 1903.

It became an important platform for discussing the problems faced by the Indian community in South Africa.

YOUNG INDIA

Young India was an English-language weekly associated with Gandhi.

It became an important platform for his writings on India's political and social situation.

The Gandhi Heritage Portal preserves hundreds of issues of Young India.

Interestingly, Gandhi's autobiography, The Story of My Experiments with Truth began appearing in Young India in 1925.

NAVAJIVAN

Navajivan was another important journal associated with Gandhi.

It was published in Gujarati and later had a Hindi edition.

Gandhi used it to communicate his thoughts about society, politics, education, self-reliance and public life.

The Gandhi Heritage Portal contains hundreds of issues of Navajivan.

HARIJAN

In 1933, Gandhi began Harijan, a weekly journal.

Its first issue is recorded as February 11, 1933.

The journal focused strongly on social issues, including Gandhi's campaign against untouchability and his efforts to promote social equality.

Related publications included Harijan Bandhu and Harijan Sevak.